About the Poet



'**Aesop's fables**' is a collection of fables credited to Aesop, a slave and a story teller believed to have lived in ancient Greece between 620 and 564 B.C.E. These fables became popular when they emerged in print. Several stories are attributed to Aesop even today. The process of inclusion is continuous and new stories are being added. Collections of Aesop's fables were among the earliest books to be printed in many languages.

Glossary

accustomed to (v) – be used to

gay (adj.) – glad, joyful

crumb (n) – piece of bread

famine (n) – extreme scarcity of food

miserly (adj.) – stingy, ungenerous

quoth (v) – said (old English usage, used only in first and third person singular befor the subject)

hastily (adv.) – hurriedly

warrant (v) – guarantee, promise

DO YOU KNOW?

Cricket is a brown or black insect related to the grasshopper but with shorter legs. It is a small insect that produces short, loud sounds by rubbing its wings together.



A. Based on your understanding of the poem, read the following lines and answer the questions given below.

1. *A silly young cricket*
   accustomed to sing
   Through the warm, sunny months of gay summer and spring.

   a) What was the routine of the cricket?

   b) Name the seasons mentioned here.

2. *Began to complain when he found that, at home,*
   His cupboard was empty, and winter was come.

   a) Who does 'he' refer to?

   b) Why was his cupboard empty?

3. *Not a crumb to be found*
   On the snow-covered ground;

   a) What couldn't he find on the ground?

   b) Why was the ground covered with snow?

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